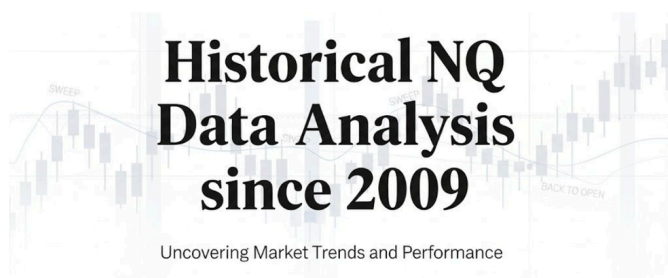


Historical Sweep + Return to Open Study on 1H Candles [NQ]



Historical Sweep and Return to Open Study on Nasdaq Futures (NQ)

By Herman Trading

Introduction

This research investigates how the Nasdaq

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Data and Methodology

Data source: BacktestMarket.com

Instrument: Nasdaq Futures (NQ)

Period covered: 2009 – August 2025

Resolution: 1-minute OHLC data

Timezone: Converted from Chicago Time (CT)
to New York Time (ET)

Weekends: Excluded (Monday–Friday only)

Each data point includes date, time, open, high,
low, close, and volume.

Because the dataset contains millions of rows, it
was processed in Python using a chunked,
memory-efficient workflow.

Analytical Framework

Python logic overview:

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python

- Resample → hourly
- Detect sweep (high/low **break**)
- Track reversion to **open** & **50%**
- Output stats + charts

This approach preserves the precision of 1-minute data while analyzing market behavior through a higher-timeframe (1H) structure, which aligns with professional trading frameworks such as ICT's killzones and session models.

Example Structure: Sweep and Return Logic

Each "range hour" (for example, 02:00–03:00 AM ET) defines a liquidity pool.

The following "trading window" (03:00–04:00 AM ET) is tested for:

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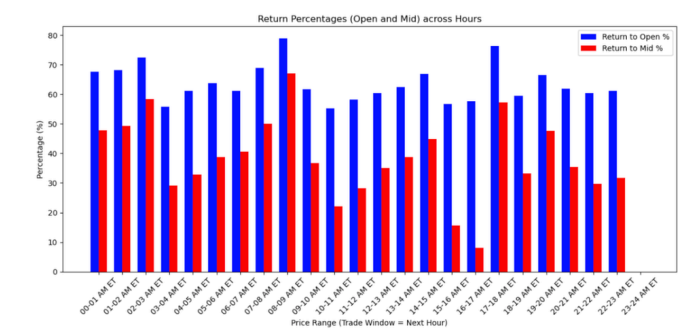
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Metric	Value
Sessions analyzed	4,291
Sweep occurred	94.7%
Return to 3AM open	72.4%
Return to 50% of range	58.4%

Results Overview

The chart below shows the percentage of times price returned to the **next hour's open** (blue) or **50% equilibrium** (red) after a sweep, across all hourly ranges.



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